



OAKRIDGE INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL
HYDERABAD, BACHUPALLY
A NORD ANGLIA EDUCATION SCHOOL



BACKGROUND GUIDE



IP

Photojournalism Style Guide



Letter from the Executive Board

Welcome, Distinguished Photojournalists,

It is with great pleasure that we welcome you to this International Press Corps simulation, where photography serves as a powerful medium for truth, expression, and change. Today, you step into the role of storytellers whose images have the ability to inform, influence, and inspire audiences across the globe.

As members of the International Press Corps, you represent the principles of press freedom, integrity, and responsible journalism. Your camera is more than a device; it is a voice that documents history, highlights human experiences, and captures moments that words alone cannot express. Every photograph you take has the potential to educate, evoke emotion, and encourage meaningful dialogue.

The objectives of this committee are:

- To deepen your understanding of the principles and ethics of photojournalism.
- To enhance your ability to communicate powerful stories through visual media.
- To foster creativity, critical thinking, and collaboration among fellow delegates.
- To recognize the impact of photography in shaping public awareness and inspiring positive change.

Throughout this simulation, you will observe, document, and interpret events through your unique perspectives. Every image you create is more than a snapshot; it is evidence of history, a reflection of reality, and a message that can transcend borders and cultures.

As you embark on this journey, let curiosity guide your vision, integrity shape your work, and compassion define your storytelling. May your photographs not only preserve unforgettable moments but also encourage understanding, spark conversations, and contribute to a more informed and connected world.

Welcome to a committee where every frame tells a story, every perspective matters, and every photograph has the power to make a difference.

We wish you an engaging, insightful, and rewarding experience.

Regards

Ch Siddharth - Director of Photojournalism



About the International Press

The International Press (IP) is not a traditional committee of the United Nations. Here, the IP refers to the collection of international press agencies that gather from all the corners of the world to report on the activities and the proceedings of various UN committees.

Introduction to Photojournalism

In a Model United Nations simulation, photojournalists are the visual storytellers of the International Press Corps. Their role goes beyond just taking pictures — to capture the essence of the conference, the emotions in debate, and the memorable moments that define the simulation. Through their lenses, they document history in the making, ensuring that every story is told not only through words but also through powerful images.

Difference Between Photography and Photojournalism

Photojournalism is a branch of photography. While both involve taking pictures, they serve different purposes. Photography is a broad field that includes many genres such as portrait, fashion, wildlife, wedding, sports, and commercial photography. It focuses on creating visually appealing images and often allows the photographer to direct subjects, adjust lighting, and edit photos for artistic or creative purposes. On the other hand, photojournalism is about capturing real events and moments to tell a true and accurate story. A photojournalist records events as they happen without staging or altering the scene, with the aim of informing people through honest visual storytelling. In simple terms, photojournalism is about documenting reality, while photography is about creating images for a variety of creative, personal, or professional goals.



Types of Assignments

There are two types of assignments for photojournalists: Coverage and Creative Assignments.

Coverage Assignments: Photojournalists are responsible for capturing the complete story of their assigned committee. They should capture debates, speeches, discussions, voting, and other important moments throughout the committee sessions. The coverage should include both wide shots and close-up shots to showcase the atmosphere, emotions, teamwork, and leadership. In addition to event coverage, photojournalists should also capture delegate group photographs, individual delegate portraits, Executive Board, Committee pictures, and double-exposure photographs (optional). All photographs should be clear, well-framed, professionally edited, and submitted in high quality. Monochrome (black-and-white) photographs should not be uploaded as part of the coverage. Only color photographs should be submitted.

Sample shots:





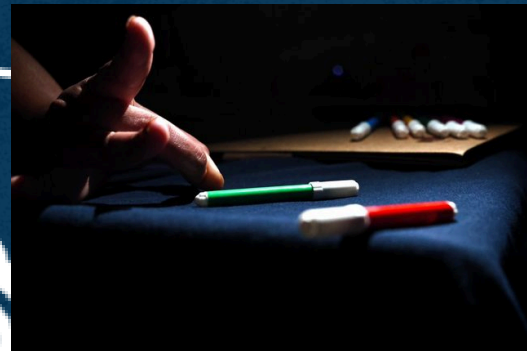
Story based:



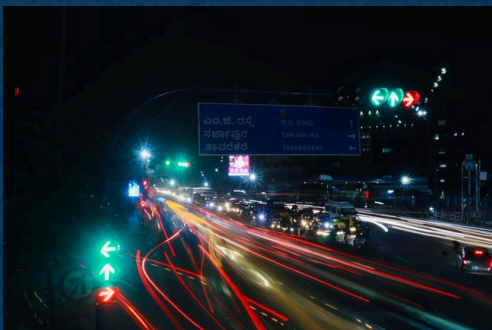


Creative Assignments : These assignments are given by the Executive Board and focus on creative and unique photography. Photojournalists should put in extra effort and creativity to make their images more visually appealing. They are encouraged to experiment with different angles, editing styles, and techniques. The main goal is to create eye-catching and impactful photographs that go beyond simple event documentation.

Abstract:

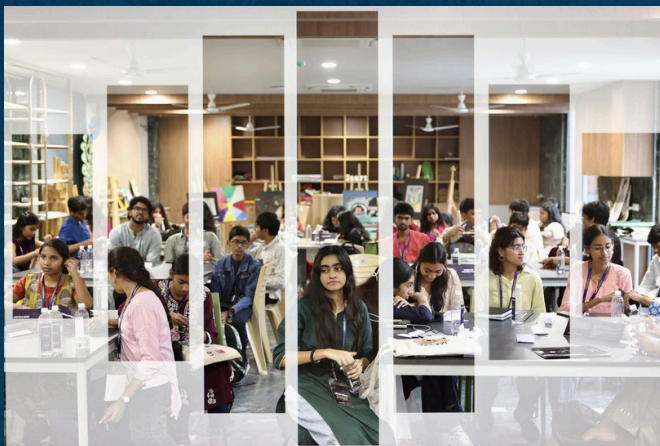


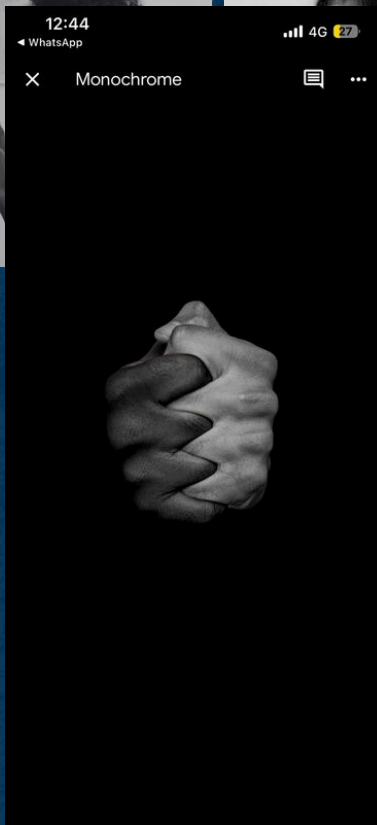
Long exposure





Frame in frame:



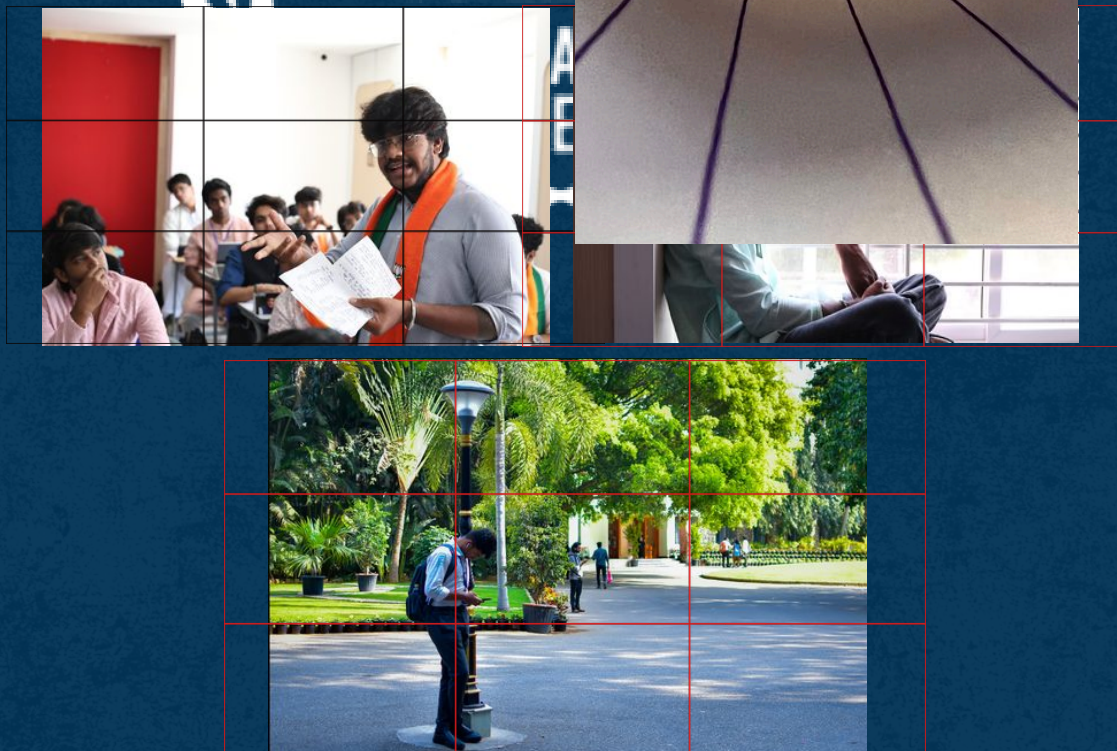




Leading lines:



Rule of thirds:





Panorama:



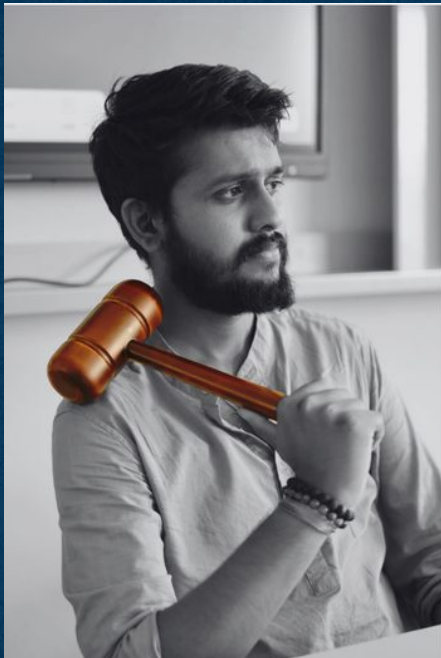


Juxtaposition:





Colour pop:



Ai Pixel Drag :



Committee Colage



Note: These are not the only creative assignments, there can be more. They are explained during the briefing, and the assignments can differ from conference to conference.



Camera Settings

The best photo depends on balancing all three settings:

- Aperture controls light and background blur.

- Shutter Speed controls motion.

- ISO controls brightness and image noise.

A good photojournalist should know how to balance Aperture, Shutter Speed, and ISO to capture clear and well-exposed photos in different situations.

1. Aperture (f-stop)

Aperture is the opening of the camera lens that controls how much light enters the camera.

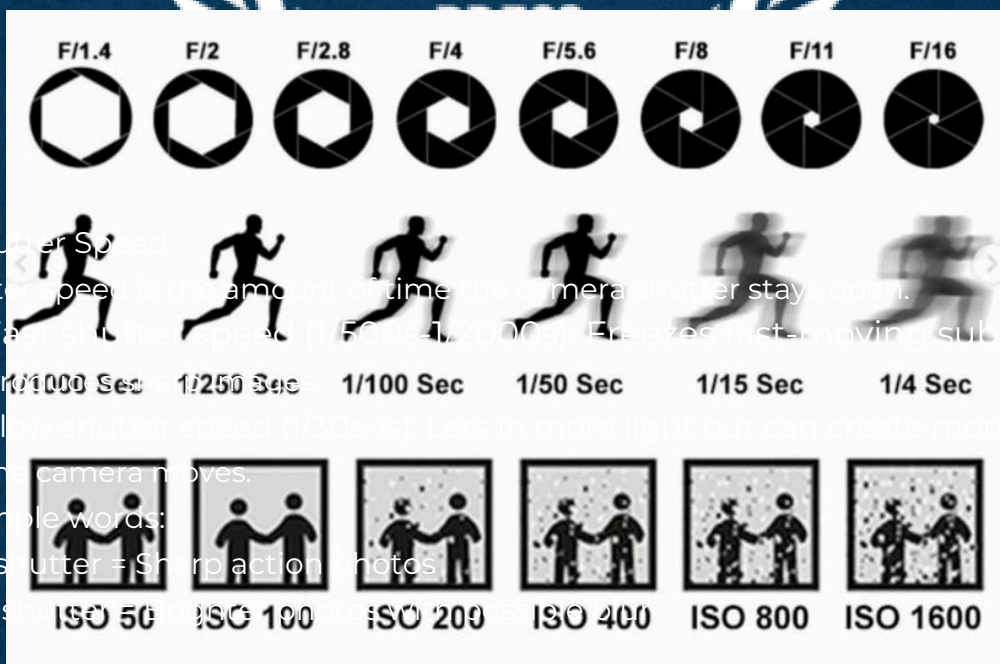
- Low f-number (f/1.8, f/2.8): More light enters, brighter image, blurred background

- High f-number (f/8, f/11, f/16): Less light enters, darker image, and more of the scene stays in focus.

In simple words:

Lower f-number = More light + Blurred background

Higher f-number = Less light + More focus



2. Shutter Speed

Shutter speed is the amount of time the camera shutter stays open.

- Fast shutter speed (1/500 to 1/2000): Freezes fast-moving subjects and

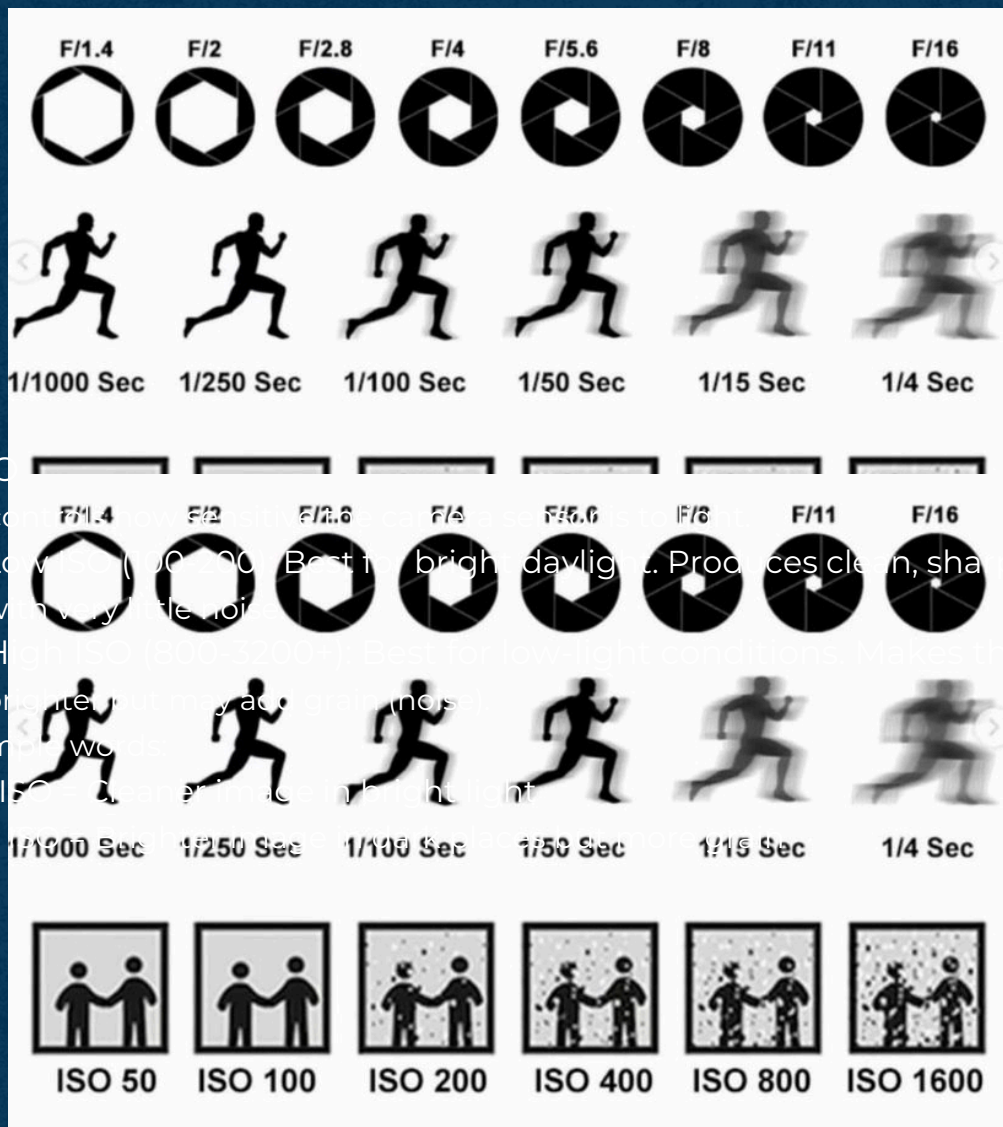
prevents motion blur.

- Slow shutter speed (1/30 to 1/4): Lets in more light but can result in motion blur if the camera moves.

In simple words:

Fast shutter = Sharp action photos

Slow shutter = Blurred motion



3. ISO

ISO controls the sensitivity of the camera sensor to light.

Low ISO (50-100) Best in bright daylight. Produces clean, sharp images with very little noise.

High ISO (800-1600) Essential in low light. Makes the image brighter but introduces visible noise.

In simple words, ISO is the camera's sensitivity to light.

Low ISO is used in bright light.

High ISO is used in low light.





Format for submission

A google drive link will be shared. In this drive link, a photojournalist must structure their own submissions with their respective names. Your submissions will be named in the following manner.

Sample format:





Rules for Photojournalists

Editing Requirements: - For coverage assignments, minimal editing is acceptable like brightness, exposure, contrast, highlights, shadow, vignette, saturation, warmth, tint, sharpness, cropping. For creative assignments, you can edit up to any extent, for ex; - color grading, adding elements etc. are allowed.

Decorum: Photojournalists are expected to maintain proper conduct and professional decorum throughout the contest. Respect for delegates, fellow journalists, organizers, and committee proceedings is mandatory. Intrusive or disruptive behavior such as cross talk and the use of flash photography will lead to scrutiny and possible disqualification.

Punctuality: All photographs must be submitted within the designated deadlines. Late submissions, regardless of quality or intent will be marked accordingly. Photojournalists are expected to manage their time efficiently to ensure timely delivery of their work. They should also stay updated through official communication channels to remain informed about event schedules, assignments, announcements, and daily submission deadlines. Timely communication and punctual submissions are essential for maintaining a smooth and efficient workflow.

Complete Coverage: Photojournalists must ensure that all significant events, moments, people, and proceedings are thoroughly captured. Selective or biased coverage will not be entertained. A comprehensive dump will be appreciated.

Structured Filing: Photographs must be systematically labelled and organized before submission. Each folder should carry essential details such as committee names organized into days. Unorganized or incorrectly labelled files will be marked accordingly.

Co-operation with Journalists: Photojournalists must work in collaboration with committee reporters to ensure seamless reporting. This includes sharing relevant visuals, aligning with storylines when needed, and maintaining open communication.



Final remarks for Photojournalists:

Anticipate what you are going to click. Moments in MUNs can pass quickly, so monitoring your camera and following through the delegates' speeches much before capturing the important moments will help. Start shooting way before the real moment arrives.

Research helps to know and tell your story. Get access to the background guides of different committees if possible, read through, and research to know what you have to possibly capture.

Reach out, interact and collaborate to bring the best out of your work. You will have fellow photojournalists, knowledgeable and sharing similar interests and goals, talk to them. You should provide good photos to your fellow reporters, communicate the requirements beforehand.

Prioritize what you want to do first. You know your tasks, you know what you are good at. Now, focus on your main idea or story. It will help manage your time better and achieve both your performance and personal goals.

Know and Practice how to use your own gear. You might be confused and not comfortable working with something you do not know how to use. Knowing what your camera is capable of is important. If you need assistance, you can always reach out to the DoP.

A photojournalist enters the scene trying to be as invisible as possible. Try to enter the committee rooms silently, be discrete, pick up your camera, and take your clicks.

